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Workplace Emotions, Attitudes, and Stress

Organizational Behavior

Emerging Knowledge, Global Reality

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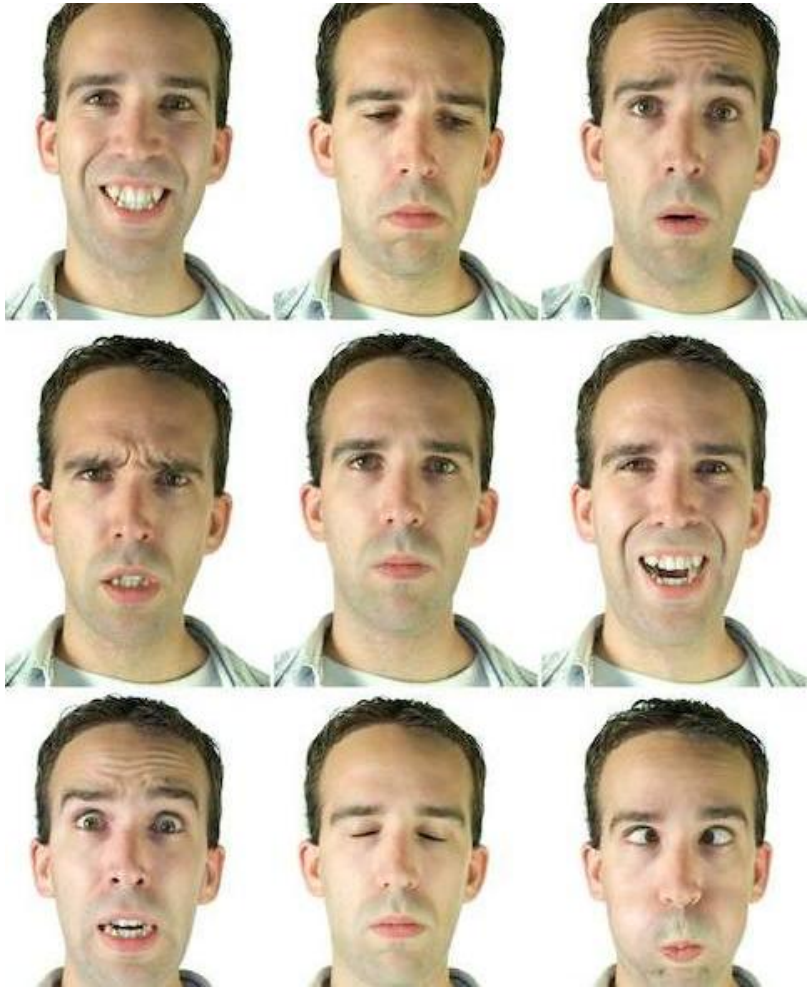
Emotions and Stress at JetBlue

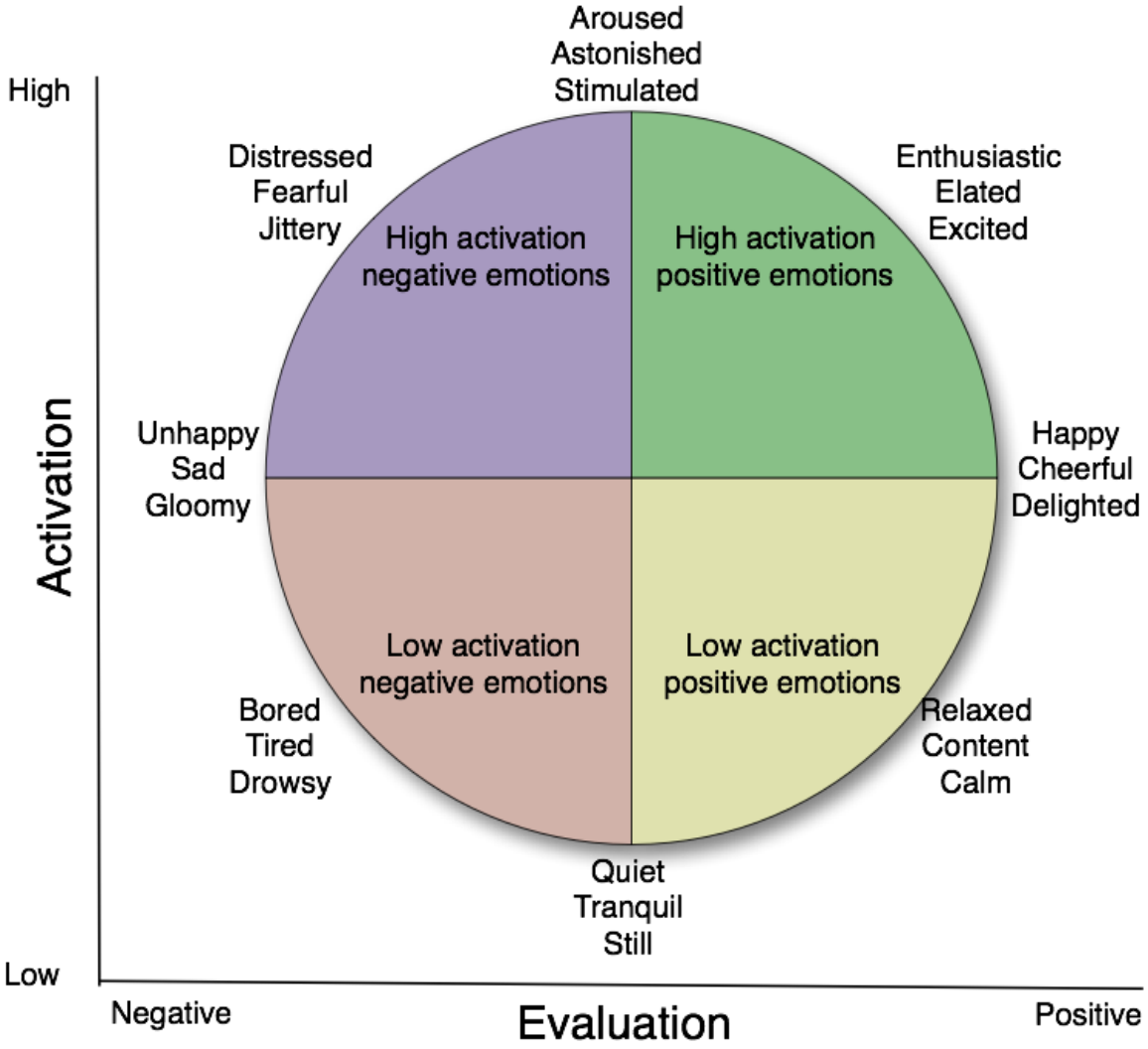
Former JetBlue employee Steven Slater (shown in photo) and other flight attendants are expected to manage their emotions on the job even when faced with significant stressors.

Emotions Defined



- Psychological, behavioral, and physiological episodes that create a state of readiness.
- Most emotions occur without our awareness
- Two features of all emotions:
  - Evaluation (core affect) – evaluate that something is good/bad
  - Activation– generate internal energy/effort

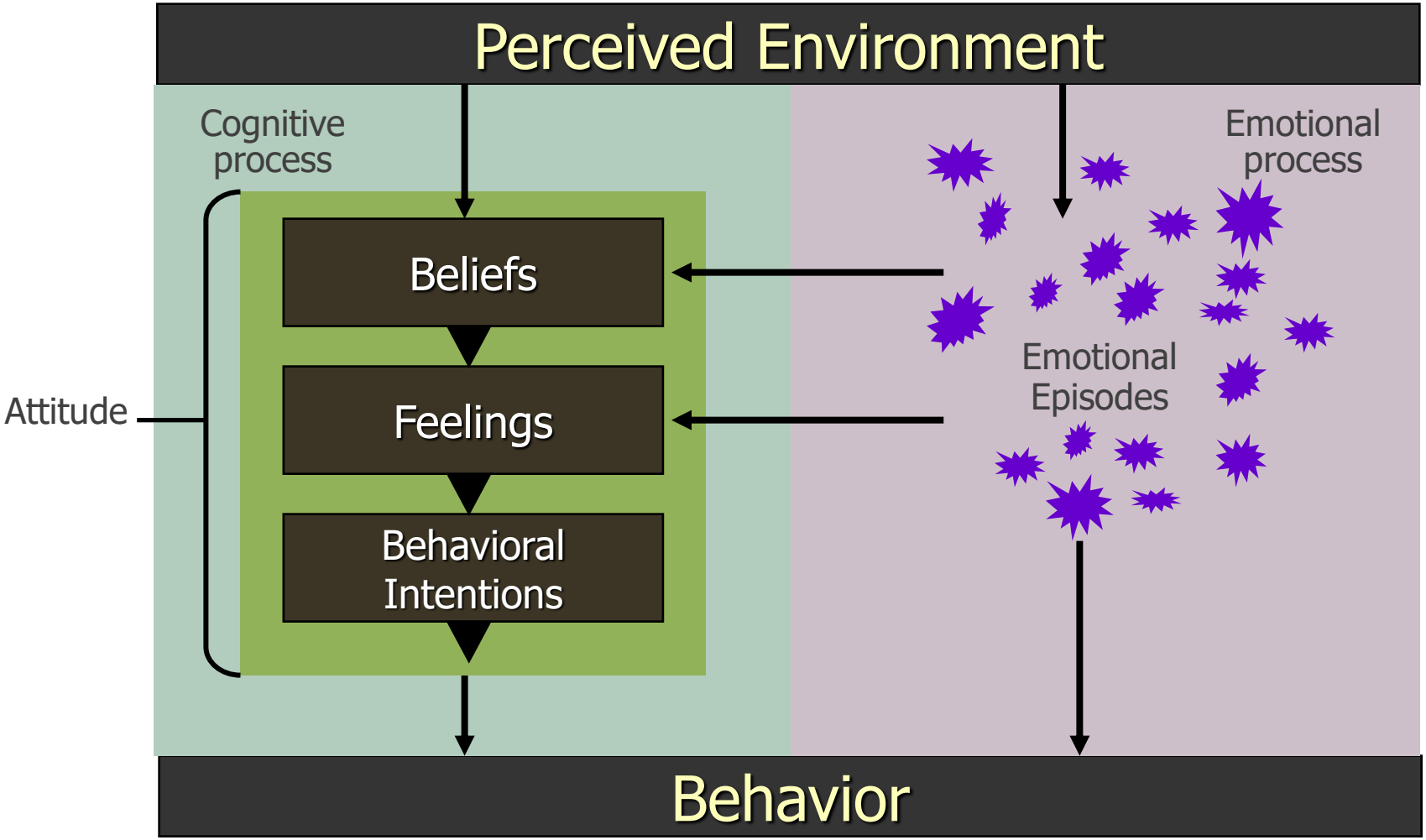
Types of Emotions



Attitudes versus Emotions

Attitudes	Emotions
Judgments about an attitude object	Experiences related to an attitude object
Based mainly on rational logic	Based on innate and learned responses to environment
Usually stable for days or longer	Usually experienced for seconds or less

Emotions, Attitudes, and Behavior Model



Traditional Model: How Attitudes Influence Behavior

- Beliefs
  - Formed from experience, other learning
- Feelings
  - Composite valences of our multiple beliefs about the attitude object
  - People with same beliefs might form different feelings
- Behavioral intentions
  - Feelings provide motivation source/direction of intentions
  - People with same feelings might form different behavioral intentions
- Behavior
  - Influenced by behavioral intentions
  - Effect of intentions on behavior depends on ability, situation, etc.

Role of Emotions in Attitudes

- Emotional markers attach to incoming sensory information
- We experience emotions from initial information and recalling it (recall activates attached markers)
- Feelings and beliefs are influenced by cumulative emotional episodes (fuzzy dots in model)
- We 'listen in' on our emotions
- Potential conflict -- cognitive vs emotional thinking
- Emotions also directly affect behavior
  - e.g. facial expression

Generating Positive Emotions at Admiral Group

Putting more fun into the workplace has helped Admiral Group become the best company to work for in the United Kingdom. "Our people spend a lot of time in work and we want to make sure that they enjoy this time," says Admiral's CEO.

Cognitive Dissonance

- Emotional experience caused by a perception that our beliefs, feelings, and behavior are incongruent.
- Inconsistency generates emotions that motivate us to increase consistency.
- Difficult to undo/change behavior
- Instead, we reduce dissonance by changing our beliefs/feelings about the attitude object

Emotional Labor

- Effort, planning and control needed to express organizationally desired emotions during interpersonal transactions.
- Higher in job requiring:
  - Frequent/lengthy emotion display
  - Variety of emotions display
  - Intense emotions display
- Emotion display norms vary across cultures
  - Expressed emotions discouraged: Ethiopia, Japan
  - Expressed emotions allowed/expected : Kuwait, Spain

Emotional Labor Challenges

- Difficult to accurately display expected emotions
- Difficult to hide true emotions
- Emotional dissonance -- conflict between true and required emotions
- Emotional labor solutions
  - Perceive emotional labor as professional skill
  - Engage in deep acting, not surface acting

Model of Emotional Intelligence

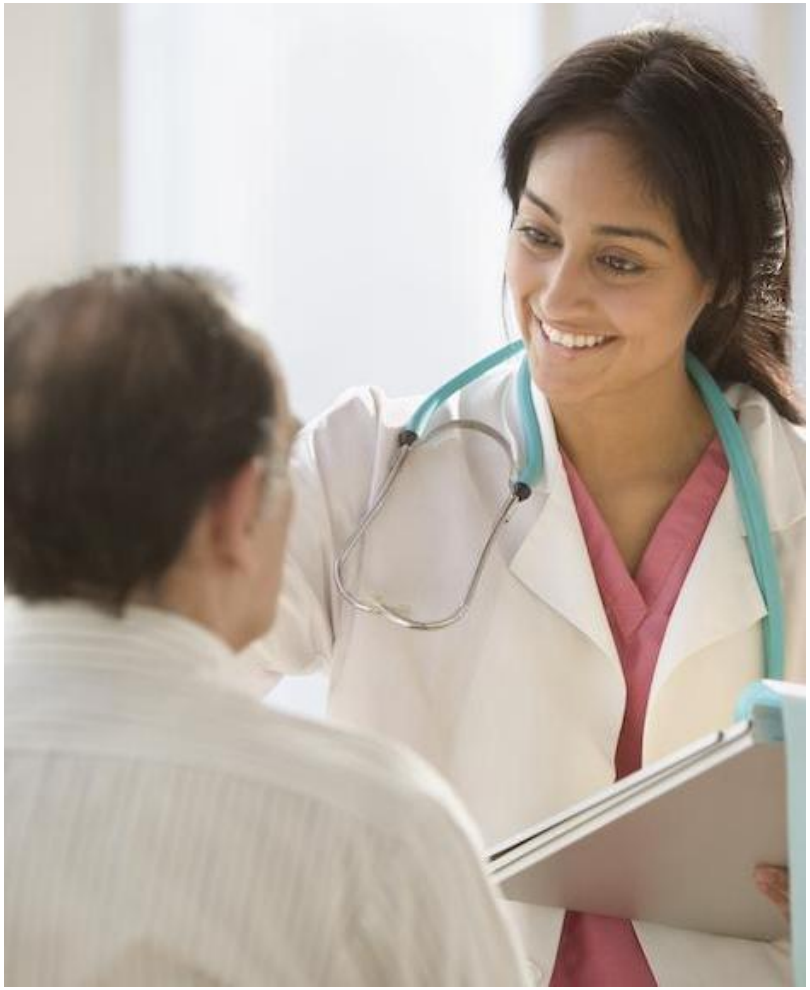
	Self (personal competence)	Other (social competence)
Recognition of emotions	Ability to know our own emotions	Ability to know others' emotions
Regulation of emotions	Ability to manage our own emotions	Ability to manage others' emotions

Emotional Intelligence Hierarchy

Highest	Ability to manage others' emotions	Increasing, decreasing, and altering emotions that others experience
	Ability to know others' emotions	Perceiving and understanding the meaning of others' emotions
	Ability to manage or own emotions	Increasing, decreasing, and altering our own emotions
Lowest	Ability to know our own emotions	Perceiving and understanding the meaning of your own emotions

Improving Emotional Intelligence

- Emotional intelligence is a set of abilities/skills
- Can be learned, especially through coaching
- EI increases with age (maturity process)



Job Satisfaction

- A person's evaluation of his or her job and work context
- An appraisal of the perceived job characteristics, work environment, and emotional experience at work

EVLN: Responses to Dissatisfaction

Exit	• Leaving the situation • Quitting, transferring
Voice	• Changing the situation • Problem solving, complaining
Loyalty	• Patiently waiting for the situation to improve
Neglect	• Reducing work effort/quality • Increasing absenteeism

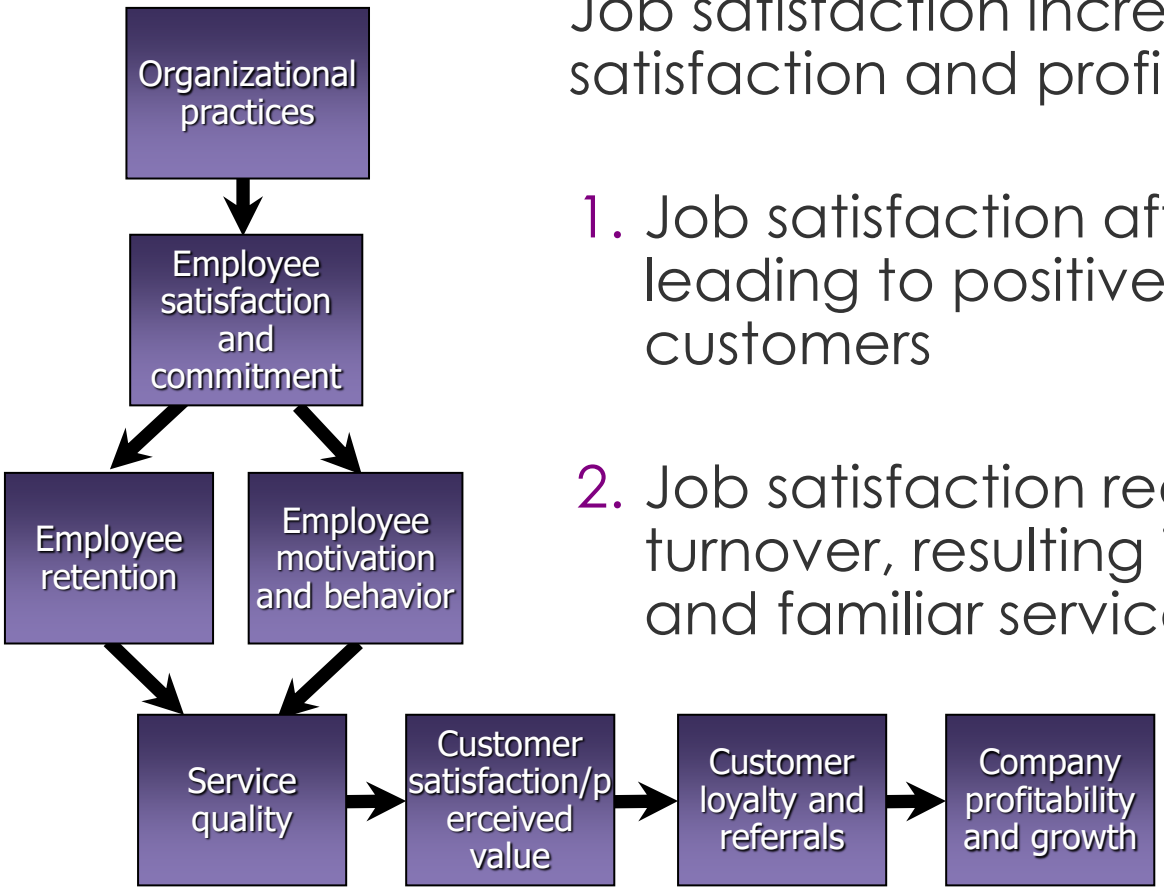
Job Satisfaction and Performance

- Happy workers are somewhat more productive workers, but relationship is weaker because:
  - General attitude vs specific behaviors
  - Low employee control over work output Job
  - Job performance isn't rewarded

Service Profit Chain at DaVita, Inc.

DaVita, Inc., the Denver-based provider of kidney care and dialysis services, generates customer satisfaction through an employee-first culture. "The attitude that teammates bring into that clinic affects patients' quality of care and their quality of life," explains a DaVita executive.

Service Profit Chain Model



Job satisfaction increases customer satisfaction and profitability because:

1. Job satisfaction affects mood, leading to positive behaviors toward customers
2. Job satisfaction reduces employee turnover, resulting in more consistent and familiar service

Organizational Commitment

- Affective commitment
  - Emotional attachment to, identification with, and involvement in an organization
  - Lower turnover, higher motivation and org citizenship
- Continuance commitment
  - Calculative attachment
  - Employees stays because (a) no choice (alternative), or (b) too costly to quit
  - Lower turnover, performance, org citizenship, cooperation

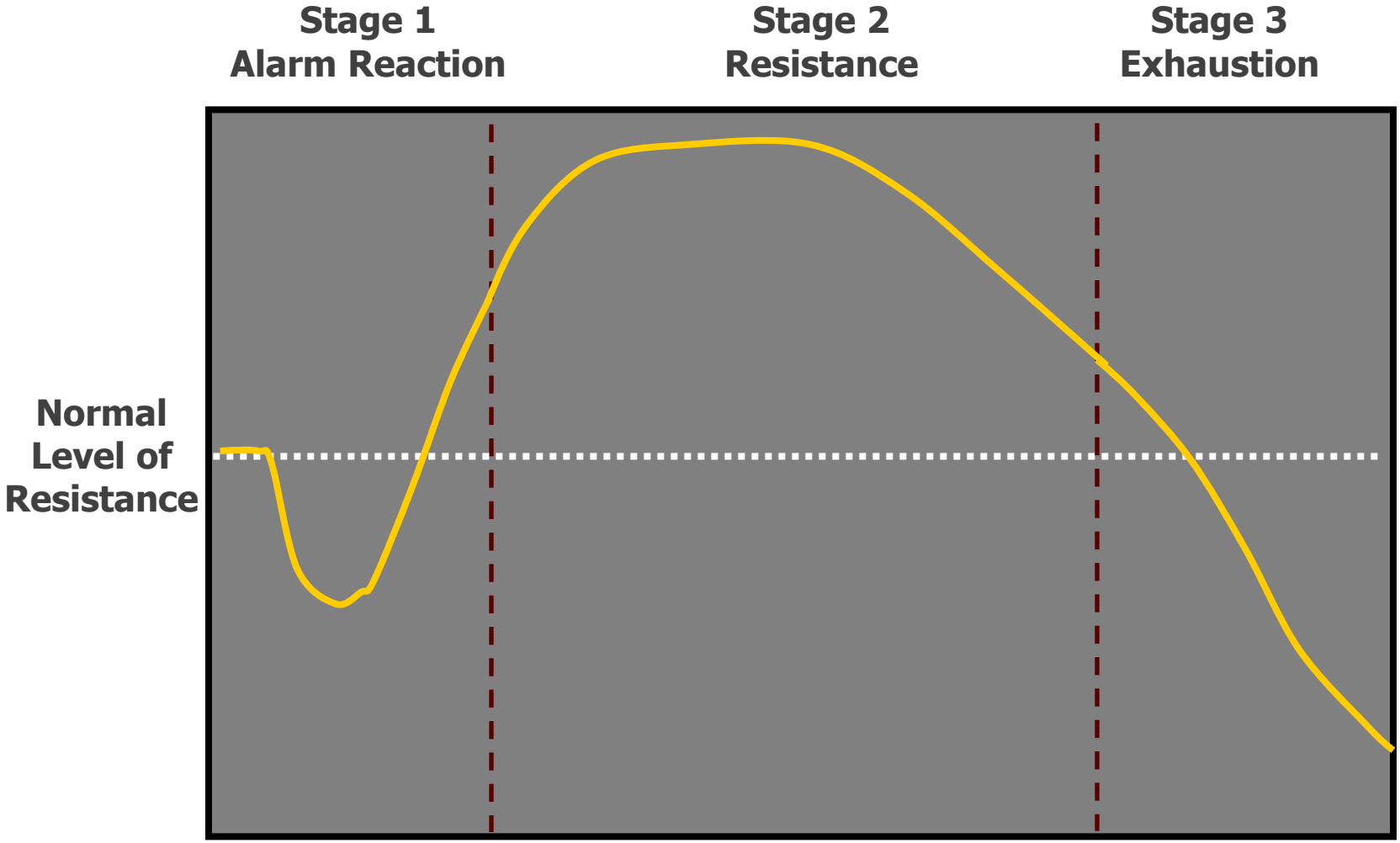
Building Affective Commitment

Justice/ Support	• Apply humanitarian values • Support employee wellbeing
Shared Values	• Values congruence
Trust	• Employees trust org leaders • Job security supports trust
Organizational Comprehension	• Know firm's past/present/future • Open and rapid communication
Employee Involvement	• Employees feel part of company • Involvement demonstrates trust

What is Stress?

- Adaptive response to situations perceived as challenging or threatening to well-being
- Prepares us to adapt to hostile or noxious environmental conditions
- Eustress vs. distress

General Adaptation Syndrome



Workplace Stressors

- Stressors are the causes of stress
  - Environmental conditions that place a physical or emotional demand on the person.
- Some common workplace stressors include:
  - Harassment an incivility
  - Work overload
  - Low task control

Individual Differences in Stress

People experience less stress and/or negative outcomes when they have:

- Better physical health – exercise, lifestyle
- Appropriate stress coping strategies
- Personality: lower neuroticism and higher extraversion
- Positive self-concept
- Lower workaholism

Managing Work-Related Stress

- Remove the stressor
  - Minimize/remove stressors
  - Work/life balance initiatives
- Withdraw from the stressor
  - Vacation, rest breaks
- Change stress perceptions
  - Positive self-concept, humor
- Control stress consequences
  - Healthy lifestyle, fitness, wellness
- Receive social support